



Call for Papers

Feminism; Influence; Inheritance

23rd March 2013

This one-day symposium hosted by the School of English and Drama at Queen Mary, University of London aims to bring together postgraduates and academics to explore how the issues of feminism, influence and inheritance animate or problematize their work and practice in the field of literary study. Through this conference we aim to begin a discussion about the challenges and anxieties, but also the significant rewards of engaging with our substantial feminist inheritance as scholars working in English Studies today. It will seek to consider how contemporary research relates to the rich, complex and extensive history of feminist research in the discipline and explore how new directions in literary study might be informed by the work of the past.

It will also provide an opportunity to reflect on inter-generational relationships between feminist researchers, on the informal or formal networks of support that exist or have existed for women academics in the field and on the way the traditions of feminism relate to the contemporary research and teaching environment.

We are delighted that Marion Shaw - Emeritus Professor, Loughborough University - will give a keynote address titled 'Old Feminism, New Feminism'.

We welcome papers that engage with any aspect of the theme of "Feminism: Influence: Inheritance". Topics may include, but are not limited to:

- The perils or promise of ideas of post-feminism; how might the tradition of feminist writing relate to changing theoretical/methodological approaches, or to changing research and teaching priorities (internal and external), within the field?
- The challenges of teaching feminism
- Feminist/ anti-feminist models of inheritance and influence
- Literary representations of the dynamics of feminist inheritance: how is the issue of feminist inheritance understood in the works of particular writers, or in particular texts?
- Negotiating the feminist scholarship in your field
- Assessing inheritance: who are the feminist writers whose influence is most significant within the field; where are the gaps and silences in contemporary understandings of the feminist inheritance?
- Approaches to dealing with problematic feminist legacies

Please send abstracts of no more than 250 words for 20 minute papers to feminism.influence.inheritance@gmail.com by 4th January 2013. Please include your name and a short biographical statement.

See feminism-influence-inheritance.blogspot.co.uk for further information and updates.